

Word family: **facility / facilities / facilitate / facilitation / facilitator**

Base word: facility

Plural: facilities

Related forms: facilitate, facilitation, facilitator

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / related verb and nouns (相關動詞及名詞)

Your sentence:

> “To me, it feels less like a public **facility** and more like a breathing space where people can slow down and think.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **facility** means a **building, place, or institution provided for a particular public purpose or service**.

In your sentence, the library is technically a public facility, but the speaker feels it has more emotional and personal value than a purely functional public building.

繁體中文： **設施；為某種公共用途、服務或活動而設置的建築物或場所**

中文翻譯：

> “...it feels less like a public **facility** ...”

「.....它不像一個單純的公共**設施 / 公共場所**.....」

Here:

public facility = 為公眾提供某種服務或用途的公共建築 / 設施

1. **facility = building/place provided for a particular purpose (設施 / 場所) — 設施；場所；機構**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: A building, place, or site that is designed and equipped for a particular activity, service, or purpose.

Practice 1 — Original

> “The library is an important public **facility**.”

「這座圖書館是一項重要的公共**設施**。」

Practice 2

> “The town has a new sports **facility**.”

「這個城鎮有一座新的運動**設施 / 場館**。」

Practice 3

> “The company operates a research **facility** nearby.”

「公司在附近營運一座研究**設施 / 研究中心**。」

****facility = 為特定用途而設置和配備的建築物、場地或機構****

Common:

- * public facility
- * sports facility
- * medical facility
- * research facility
- * storage facility
- * manufacturing facility

2. ****facilities = equipment/services/amenities available for use (配套設施) — 設施 ; 設備 ; 服務****

In the plural, ****facilities**** often means the equipment, spaces, or services available in a place.

Practice 4

> “The hotel has excellent **facilities**.”

「這間酒店的**設施 / 配套**非常好。」

Practice 5

> “The school provides good sports **facilities**.”

「學校提供良好的運動**設施**。」

****facilities = 某地方提供給人使用的設備、空間或服務配套****

Common:

- * hotel facilities
- * sports facilities
- * leisure facilities
- * washing facilities
- * parking facilities

This is extremely common and worth separating from a single physical facility.

3. **facilities** = toilets/restrooms (委婉) — 洗手間 ; 廁所

In polite or formal English, especially in signs and service contexts, **facilities** can mean toilets.

Practice 6

> “Are there any **facilities** nearby?”

「附近有**洗手間**嗎？」

Practice 7

> “The **facilities** are on the ground floor.”

「**洗手間**在地下樓層。」

facilities = 洗手間 / 廁所的委婉說法

This is a lexicalized plural use and should be taught explicitly.

4. **facility** = natural ability/ease in doing something (能力) — 熟練 ; 才能 ; 天分

Facility can also mean a natural or developed ability to do something easily and skilfully.

Practice 8

> “She has a remarkable **facility** for languages.”

「她對語言有非常出色的**天分 / 學習能力**。」

Practice 9

> “He speaks with great **facility**.”

「他說話非常**流暢自如**。」

facility = 做某件事時表現出的熟練、容易或天賦

Common:

* facility with languages

* facility for mathematics

* verbal facility

This is a genuinely distinct abstract sense.

5. **facility** = ease/readiness in doing something (容易程度) — 容易 ; 熟練自如

In more formal English, **facility** can refer to the ease with which something is done.

Practice 10

> “She answered the questions with surprising **facility**.”

「她非常**輕鬆熟練地**回答了那些問題。」

Practice 11

> “He moves between languages with great **facility**.”

「他能非常**自如地**在不同語言之間切換。」

with facility = 輕鬆、熟練、自如地

For strict counting, I would merge this with Meaning 4.

6. **facility** = industrial/technical site (工業 / 技術) — 廠房 ; 設施基地

Facility is very common in industrial and technical contexts.

Practice 12

> “The company opened a new production **facility**.”

「公司開設了一座新的生產**設施 / 廠房**。」

Practice 13

> “Waste is processed at a treatment **facility**.”

「廢物會在處理**設施**中進行處理。」

****facility = 為生產、儲存、處理、研究等特定用途設立的工業或技術場所****

For core counting, this belongs to Meaning 1.

Related form: ****facilitate****

****Facilitate**** means to make a process, action, or event easier or more likely to happen smoothly.

Practice 14

> “The new system will ****facilitate**** communication.”

「新系統將有助****促進 / 方便****溝通。」

Practice 15

> “The teacher helped ****facilitate**** the discussion.”

「老師協助****促進****討論順利進行。」

****facilitate = 使某件事更容易進行、更順暢或更容易發生****

This is semantically related but should be treated as a family extension, not a meaning of ****facility****.

Related form: ****facilitation****

****Facilitation**** means the process of making something easier or helping it run smoothly.

Practice 16

> “Good ****facilitation**** can improve group discussions.”

「良好的****引導 / 促進技巧****可以改善小組討論。」

****facilitation = 協助某個過程順利進行的行為或方法****

Related form: ****facilitator****

A ****facilitator**** is a person who helps a group, meeting, or process work effectively.

Practice 17

> “The workshop was led by an experienced ****facilitator****.”

「工作坊由一位有經驗的****引導員 / 主持人****帶領。」

****facilitator = 協助討論、活動或流程順利進行的人****

Important distinction: ****facility vs building****

****building****

simply means a physical structure.

****facility****

means a building or site designed for a particular function.

> office building

> medical facility

So a facility is usually defined by ****purpose****, not just physical form.

Important distinction: ****facility vs amenity****

****facility****

can mean a functional place, room, or piece of infrastructure.

****amenity****

usually means a feature or service that makes a place more pleasant or convenient.

- > sports facility
- > hotel amenities

They overlap, especially in plural usage.

Important distinction: **facility vs equipment**

equipment

means tools, machines, or devices.

facility

can include the entire place, room, service, and supporting infrastructure.

- > laboratory equipment
- > laboratory facility

Not the same scale.

Important distinction: **facility vs institution**

institution

means an established organization, especially social, educational, financial, or governmental.

facility

emphasizes the physical site or functional provision.

- > educational institution
- > training facility

A facility may belong to an institution.

Important distinction: **facility vs ability**

ability

is the broad word for being capable of doing something.

facility

suggests ease, fluency, or natural skill.

- > ability to learn languages
- > facility for languages

The second implies doing it particularly easily or skilfully.

Important distinction: **facility vs skill**

skill

means learned competence.

facility

often emphasizes how naturally or easily the skill is performed.

- > writing skill
- > facility with words

Countability note

This word changes grammar by sense.

Countable — building/place

- > a facility
- > several facilities

Usually plural — amenities/equipment

- > sports facilities
- > hotel facilities

Usually singular/uncountable-like — ability/ease

- > facility with languages
- > with great facility

This is a useful learner distinction.

Useful construction: **facility for / facility with — 對……有天生 / 很熟練**

Practice 18

> “She has a natural **facility for** learning languages.”

「她天生很有學語言的**天分**。」

Practice 19

> “He has great **facility with** numbers.”

「他處理數字非常**熟練 / 有天生**。」

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

- * **facility**
- * **facilities**
- * **facilitate**
- * **facilitation**
- * **facilitator**

The major curation split is between:

- * a **functional place or set of amenities**
- * an **ability to do something easily**

The many domain examples—medical facility, research facility, production facility, public facility—should remain under the same underlying physical-purpose sense rather than be split artificially.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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facility — building/site	為某種特定用途或服務而設計、配備的建築物、場所或機構
facilities — amenities/equipment	某個地方提供給人使用的設備、空間或服務配套
facilities — toilets	洗手間 / 廁所的委婉說法

facility — ability/ease	做某件事時表現出的天分、熟練程度或輕鬆自如的能力	
facilitate	使某個過程、活動或事情更容易、更順暢地進行	
facilitation	協助某件事順利進行的過程	
facilitator	協助小組、討論或流程順利進行的人	

For your original sentence

> “To me, it feels less like a public **facility** and more like a breathing space...”

The exact meaning is:

facility = 為公眾提供特定服務或用途的建築物 / 場所

So:

> **public facility**

= **公共設施 / 公共服務場所**

The contrast in the sentence is important:

> **public facility**

> = functional, practical public building

versus

> **breathing space**

> = a personally meaningful place of calm and relief

For your database, I would count **3 genuinely useful core meanings** for **facility**:

1. **a building/place/site designed for a particular purpose**
2. **plural facilities = equipment, amenities, and services available for use**
3. **ability/ease in doing something**

I would keep **facilities = toilets** as an important lexicalized plural extension, merge industrial/medical/research uses into #1, and keep **facilitate / facilitation / facilitator** as family extensions rather than inflate the noun count.